

» NEXT GENERATION CUP



HEROES OF THE FUTURE

Indian football looks for a silver lining through the **Next Generation** Cup 2024.

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In recent months, Indian football has descended into the dungeons of disappointment, marked by a loss to lower-ranked Afghanistan, an exit from the FIFA World Cup 2026 race, and the retirement of its highest goalscorer, Sunil Chhetri.

The situation worsened when two Indian teams, the under-21 sides of East Bengal and Muthoot Football Academy, suffered damaging defeats in the Next Generation Cup 2024, conceding 32 goals and scoring only two goals across eight matches.

However, hope, like a phoenix, rose from the ashes of despair through the young players of Punjab FC. The under-21 side of the Indian Super League (ISL) outfit delivered a remarkable



PREMIER LEAGUE FOR INDIA